

Louis Ledoux

Associate Professor – Maître de conférences

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“Post Hoc Ergo Propter Hoc”

Research Interests

- **Hardware Design & Synthesis:** Floating-Point Units, Systolic Arrays, Tensor Accelerators, FPGAs, ASIC Design, RTL generation
- **Computer Arithmetic:** Number Representations, FloPoCo, Posit & IEEE 754 Standards, Fixed-Point Polynomial Approximations, Accuracy–Energy Tradeoffs
- **High Performance Computing:** BLAS, GEMMs, Heterogeneous Workloads, Numerical Analysis, Supercomputing
- **End-to-End EDA Flows:** From mathematical problem to silicon implementation, integrating MLIR-based compilation, RTL generation, and open-source silicon flows

Experience

- 2026 – Now **Associate Professor (*Maître de conférences*)**, [Université de Rennes – ISTIC](#), Rennes
Teaching-and-research faculty member (*enseignant-chercheur*) at ISTIC, with research in [IRISA](#)’s Architecture Department (D3) as a member of the [Inria Taran](#) project-team.
○ Contributing to the design and tapeout of AI accelerators within the national [PEPR CAMELIA](#) program.
○ Designing systolic-array and tensor architectures with small-format floating-point arithmetic.
- 2025 – 2026 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, [INSA/INRIA – Emeraude](#), Lyon
Working on arithmetic compilation and optimization within the *Emeraude* team, at the intersection of *MLIR*, *HAriCo/FloPoCo*, *CIRCT*, *Faust*, and open EDA/hardware flows. The research focuses on bridging high-level mathematical reasoning with low-level hardware synthesis and reproducible compiler-to-silicon validation.
○ Developed multi-level arithmetic transformations and MLIR dialects for fixed-point approximation, ASIC, and FPGA targets.
○ Automated hardware generation from DSP code and contributed to FloPoCo’s refactoring toward explicit IR-based circuit generation.
○ Presented results at *DSD 2025*, *EuroLLVM 2025*, the *PEPR IA Embarquée* workshop in Aussois (2026), and *EuroLLVM 2026*.
- 2018 – 2024 **Researcher**, [Barcelona Supercomputing Center \(BSC\) - RoMoL/CAOS/SONAR](#), Barcelona
As a BSC researcher during my PhD, I published peer-reviewed papers, attended international conferences, and developed software toolchains and hardware designs for numerical acceleration. The conducted research is summarized as follows:
○ Explored co-designed hardware/software acceleration of posit arithmetic for FPGA and ASIC technologies, and POWER9 hosts.
○ Developed Kulisch/Quire accumulators for any floating-point representation.
○ Conducted accuracy and energy budgeting tailored to workload numerical requirements.
○ Designed Systolic Array architecture for HPC workloads with three directions of data flow, infinite number representations, and tailored internal precision.
○ Proposed serialized, area-efficient division units targeting the SIMD/Vector paradigm at the architecture level, further improving the parallelism/latency/energy ratio.
- 2017 - 2018 **Hardware Engineer**, [b⟨⟩com](#), Rennes
Coop student under a professionalization contract during my final year of study. Engaged in one year of R&D focused on FPGA acceleration in the cloud, aiming to evaluate the feasibility of these novel solutions.
○ Successfully integrated an IP (real-time SDR to HDR) to convert video from NVMe to NVMe through cloud FPGA.
○ Developed the IP integration using HDLs and tweaked PCIe drivers (EDMA and XDMA).
○ Scheduled user processes asynchronously with OpenCL to overlap reads and writes, successfully saturating PCIe bandwidth (≈ 15.8 GB/s).
○ Traveled to [Xilinx XDF Frankfurt 2018](#) to conduct operational monitoring and analysis.
Keywords: SDAccel, OpenCL, Xilinx FPGA (UltraScale VU9P), VHDL, SystemVerilog, AWS F1 instances, Linux driver, Linux kernel, PCIe, C++1x, C, DMA, AaaS (Acceleration as a Service), FaaS (FPGA as a Service), Virtual Machine, Docker, PCIe virtual functions.

July 2017 **Backend Developer**, *WaryMe*, Rennes

Summer internship focused on developing the entire back end of a people security application.

- Designed and implemented backend services and APIs.
- Ensured secure data transmission using HTTPS and Let's Encrypt.
- Deployed and managed the application on AWS with PM2 and Nginx.
- Automated deployment processes with Jenkins.
- Collaborated with front-end developers using Angular and TypeScript.

Keywords: Node.js, Git, C++, C, Angular, TypeScript, HTTPS, Let's Encrypt, PM2, Nginx, AWS, Jenkins.

July 2016 **Backend Developer**, *ASKIA*, Paris 10ème

During this summer internship, I developed an automated CLI tool for publishing surveys on popular platforms such as GitHub and Zendesk. **Key Concepts:** Node.js, HTTP(S), REST API, Git, Test-Driven Development (TDD), Event-Driven/Asynchronous Programming, Jasmine Framework, Mocks, Stubs.

July 2014 **Electronics Technician**, *Radio Electronique Rennaise (R.E.R.)*, Rennes

As an electronics technician, I was responsible for repairing various electronic devices from customers, with an emphasis on audio equipment. Tasks included soldering, reverse engineering amplifier circuits, welcoming customers, and sorting/ordering electronic parts.

Education

2018 – 2024 **PhD Student**, *Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya (UPC)*, Barcelona

Supervisor: Marc Casas Guix. Thesis title: “Floating-Point Arithmetic Paradigms for High-Performance Computing: Software Algorithms and Hardware Designs”. Jury members attributed the **excellent** grade. • HAL:tel-04754167.

2015 – 2018 **Engineering School**, *ESIR*, Université de Rennes

Completed a three-year program culminating in an **Engineer diploma** certified by the CTI (Comité des Titres d'Ingénieurs) and a **Master's degree** (Magister) in Computer Science.

2013 – 2015 **Classe Préparatoire**, *CUPGE ESIR*, Université de Rennes

Intensive program with a strong emphasis on Mathematics and Computer Sciences.

Teaching (*University teaching load: 100h*)

August 2026 **Course Instructor – Digital Design with MLIR and CIRCT**, *ACM Europe School on MLIR 2026*, A Coruña, Spain

Designed and delivered a 1h45 interactive course for an international audience, using quizzes and guided exercises to teach digital-design fundamentals and practical MLIR/CIRCT flows: IR lowering, optimization, equivalence checking, logic synthesis, and SystemVerilog generation. Developed a capstone in which participants lowered E4M3 floating-point multiplication from `arith.mulf` to `hw/comb` circuitry; demonstrated the end-to-end path from MLIR input to a small Sky130 ASIC GDSII layout, alongside a taped-out TinyTapeout GF0P2 design. [Course slides](#) • [source and exercises](#).

2026 **Computer Architecture (ARC)**, *INSA Lyon*, Lyon

Practical sessions in computer architecture for the Telecommunications curriculum, covering instruction execution, pipelining, cache memories, performance evaluation, and RISC-V assembly programming.

Level: 1st year of engineering school (Telecommunications track, 3TC); Teaching load: 24h

2026 **Operating Systems (SYS)**, *INSA Lyon*, Lyon

Core operating system mechanisms, including kernel and system calls, process scheduling, virtual memory, concurrency, and file systems.

Level: 1st year of engineering school / Bachelor equivalent (Computer Science, INSA 3IF); Teaching load: 16h

2026 **Long-Term Project in Compilation (PLD-COMP)**, *INSA Lyon*, Lyon

Supervision of long-term group projects on compiler design and implementation, covering intermediate representations, program analysis, and backend code generation.

Level: 2nd year of engineering school / Master 1 (Computer Science, INSA 4IF); Teaching load: 36h

2025 – 2026 **Computer Architecture (AO)**, *INSA Lyon*, Lyon

Problem-solving and practical sessions on processor organization and instruction set architectures, based on the MSP430 microcontroller, including instruction execution, addressing modes, and memory hierarchy.

Level: 1st year of engineering school / Bachelor equivalent (Computer Science, INSA 3IF); Teaching load: 12h

2025 – 2026 **Digital Design (AC)**, *INSA Lyon*, Lyon

Exercises and guided sessions on digital circuit design, including combinational and sequential logic, finite state machines, and introductory hardware description languages.

Level: 1st year of engineering school / Bachelor equivalent (Computer Science, INSA 3IF); Teaching load: 12h

International Peer-reviewed Journals

[Bar+26] B. Barbe, **L. Ledoux**, A. Volkova, and F. de Dinechin, “Reconfigurable constant multipliers: hardware models, optimization algorithm and applications,” *Microprocessors and Microsystems*, 2026. • [DOI](#) • HAL:05510936.

[Pop+25] M. Popoff, R. Michon, T. Risset, P. Cochard, **L. Ledoux**, et al., “Frugality and circuit design for digital audio signal processing,” *Revue Francophone d'Informatique et Musique*, special issue “Frugalité, pérennité et création,” vol. 11, 2025. • [DOI](#) • HAL:05489376.

- [Led+25b] **L. Ledoux**, P. Cochard, and F. de Dinechin, “Towards optimized arithmetic circuits with MLIR,” *WiPiEC Journal* (Works in Progress in Embedded Computing), vol. 11, no. 1, 2025, Salerno, Italy. Associated conference presentation at the Euromicro Conference on Digital System Design (DSD). • [DOI](#) • [HAL:05385229](#).

International Peer-reviewed Conference Papers

- [Led25] **L. Ledoux**, “Design-space exploration of serialized floating-point division for DLP architectures,” in *28th Euromicro Conference Series on Digital System Design (DSD 2025)*, Salerno, Italy. • [DOI](#) • [HAL:05385247](#).
- [LC23a] **L. Ledoux** and M. Casas, “An open-source framework for efficient numerically-tailored computations,” in *33rd International Conference on Field-Programmable Logic and Applications (FPL 2023)*, Gothenburg, Sweden. • [DOI](#) • [arXiv:2406.02579](#) • [HAL:04277512](#).
- [LC22] **L. Ledoux** and M. Casas, “A generator of numerically-tailored and high-throughput accelerators for batched GEMMs,” in *30th IEEE International Symposium on Field-Programmable Custom Computing Machines (FCCM 2022)*, May 2022, pp. 1–10, New York, USA. • [DOI](#) • [HAL:04103774](#).

Tutorials, Workshops & Demos

- MLIRW26 **7th MLIR Workshop @ EuroLLVM 2026**, Dublin, Ireland, April 13, 2026. *Talk*. Progressive Arithmetic Lowering from Tensor Kernels to Synthesizable Datapaths. • [HAL:05594483](#).
- ARITH26 **ARITH 2026**, Fulda, Germany, June 28 – July 1, 2026. *Scheduled demo*. End-to-end compilation from Python matrix multiplication and activation functions to silicon, with OpenROAD EDA catching optimization opportunities in between.

Contributions to Publications

- [Ven24] Contributor (not a listed author) to: M. Venn, “Tiny Tapeout: a shared silicon tapeout platform accessible to everyone,” *IEEE Solid-State Circuits Magazine*, 2024. Initiated manuscript drafting, ensured academic formatting, and contributed to revision. • [IEEE article](#) • [manuscript commits](#).

Poster Presentations

- [Led26e] **L. Ledoux**, “HARiCo: Floating-Point MLIR to CIRCT Datapaths,” in *ACM Europe School on MLIR 2026*, A Coruña, Spain, August 10–14, 2026.
- [Led26d] **L. Ledoux**, “Multi-Level Compilation of AI Tensors and Activation Functions to Silicon,” in *PEPR IA Days*, Rennes, France, June 22–24, 2026. • [HAL:05671676](#).
- [Led+26c] **L. Ledoux**, P. Cochard, and F. de Dinechin, “Progressive Arithmetic Optimizations: Tensor and DSP Kernels to Synthesizable Datapaths,” • *3rd FPGA Developers’ Forum (FDF) meeting*, CERN, May 27–29, 2026. • [HAL:05631193v1](#).
- [Led+26b] **L. Ledoux**, P. Cochard, and F. de Dinechin, “Floating-Point Datapaths in CIRCT via HARiCo and harico-arith-to-comb Lowering,” in *EuroLLVM Developers’ Meeting 2026*, Dublin, Ireland. • [HAL:05576131](#).
- [Led+26a] **L. Ledoux**, P. Cochard, and F. de Dinechin, “Arithmetic lowering with Emeraude-MLIR: bridging tensor and DSP kernels to silicon datapaths,” Aussois, France. • [HAL:05489427](#).
- [Led+25a] **L. Ledoux**, P. Cochard, L. Forget, and F. de Dinechin, “Towards multi-level arithmetic optimizations,” in *EuroLLVM 2025*, Berlin, Germany. • [HAL:05063466](#).
- [LC24b] **L. Ledoux** and M. Casas, “LLMMM: large language models matrix-matrix multiplications characterization on open silicon,” in *11th BSC Severo Ochoa Doctoral Symposium 2024*, Barcelona, Spain. • [HAL:04592229](#).
- [LC24a] **L. Ledoux** and M. Casas, “The grafted superset approach: bridging Python to silicon with asynchronous compilation and beyond,” in *4th Workshop on Open-Source Design Automation (OSDA 2024)*, hosted at DATE, Valencia, Spain. • [HAL:04587458](#).
- [LC23b] **L. Ledoux** and M. Casas, “Open-source GEMM hardware kernels generator: toward numerically-tailored computations,” in *10th BSC Severo Ochoa Doctoral Symposium 2023*, Barcelona, Spain. • [arXiv:2305.18328](#) • [HAL:04094835](#).

Invited Talks & Seminars

- [LC25] **L. Ledoux** and P. Cochard, “FloPoCo and MLIR: a multi-level compilation framework for many intents,” Holigrail Seminar, Sorbonne University, Paris, France, September 18, 2025. • [HAL:05412130](#).
- [Led24] **L. Ledoux**, “The walls and the dark silicon era: an arithmetic perspective,” seminar at Inria Rennes (Team TARAN), Rennes, France, December 2, 2024. • [HAL:04823130](#).
- [LC19] **L. Ledoux** and M. Casas, “Accelerating DL inference with (Open)CAPI and posit numbers,” in *OpenPOWER Summit Europe 2019*, Lyon, France. • [HAL:04094850](#).

Conference Peer Reviewing

2026 [FCCM 2026](#) (×1), [ASAP 2026](#) (×2), and [ICECS 2026](#) (×1).

Conference Organization Experience

- LAC25 **Linux Audio Conference**, Lyon, France (2025). *Technician*. Responsible for sound, YouTube streaming, and microphone management. [event website](#).
- JIM25 **Journées de l'Informatique Musicale**, Lyon, France (2025). *Technician*. Responsible for sound, YouTube streaming, and microphone management. [event website](#).
- HC32 **HotChips 32nd**, Remote (Digital), SARS-CoV-2 Period (2020). *Remote Assistant*. Assisted with digital entrance management, conference link distribution, and attendee support during the event. [event website](#).
- FPL29 **Field-Programmable Logic Conference 29th**, Barcelona, Spain (2019). *Reception and Entrance Coordinator*. Managed reception desk activities, including badge distribution and providing microphones for speakers during presentations. [event website](#).

Internship Mentoring

2026 – Now **Esteban Wybouw**, “Porting FloPoCo to HArCo: an IR-based core generation framework for multi-HDL hardware generation,” co-supervised with Florent de Dinechin and Pierre Cochard.

Academic Summer Schools and Workshops

- 2021 **ACM Europe Summer School on High Performance Computing**, Barcelona, Spain. *Participant*. Attended lectures and hands-on sessions covering exascale architectures, programming models, and numerical methods. [school website](#).
- 2019 **Yale Patt’s Computer Architecture Summer School**, Barcelona, Spain. *Participant*. Attended the special summer edition of Prof. Yale Patt’s course on out-of-order execution and advanced microarchitectural design.
- 2019 **Xilinx Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence Seminar**, Paris, France. *Participant*. Technical seminar focused on machine learning workloads and AI acceleration platforms.
- 2019 **PRACE Summer School on Heterogeneous Programming with OmpSs@FPGA**, Barcelona, Spain. *Participant*. Training on FPGA-based acceleration and heterogeneous programming using the OmpSs@FPGA model.

Technology Development: Software & Hardware

Software  [SUF](#): OpenROAD-based ASIC design-space exploration and flow orchestration;  [OSFNTC](#): numerically-tailored GEMM generator with PyTorch/NumPy/OpenBLAS/OpenCAPI integration;  [MLModelMLIRGEN](#): PyTorch/torchvision→MLIR exporter.

Hardware IP  [POF](#): SystemVerilog Posit operators, datapaths, quires, and verification benches; [FloPoCo](#): Virtex Ultra-Scale+ timing model, systolic-array generator work, and HArCo/IR-oriented refactoring.

Utilities  [VH2V](#): VHDL→Verilog bridge for open ASIC flows;  [OpenROAD GPL](#): placement visualization and chip-shaping experiments;  [gdsiistl](#): GDSII→STL layout visualization;  [Codez](#): Typst/CeTZ annotated code figures with MLIR/Python/SystemVerilog support.

Upstream  [CIRCT PR9263](#) and  [PR9245](#): arithmetic lowering and HDL-oriented transforms;  [oc-accel](#) and  [capi2-bsp](#): OpenCAPI/CAPI2 accelerator support;  [OpenROAD PR](#): Arch/Manjaro installer support.

Tapeouts [MPW5 Sky130](#): posit/Quire systolic array; [TT GF0P2](#): Faust→MLIR→silicon soft-clipper; [TT SKY26A](#): MLIR→floating-point accumulator;  [IHP BF16](#) and  [IHP IEEE754](#): CMOS5L floating-point lowering demonstrators; [TT SKY25B](#): modified-placement demonstrator; [MPW1](#) and [MPW4](#): integration contributions.

Languages

French Native

Spanish Native (with an honest French accent)

English Full Proficiency